

THE 5 THINGS BIG ADVERTISERS DO THAT YOU DON'T

Real strategies. Real breakdowns.
Steal them for your own ads.

INSIDE THIS SWIPE FILE:

- 01 — Why big advertisers NEVER rely on a single audience
- 02 — The creative testing system they use to find winners fast
- 03 — How they track every euro without losing a single conversion
- 04 — The retargeting stack that recovers lost buyers automatically
- 05 — Why they always sell the outcome, never the product

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By Davi Wazlawick · Paid Media Strategist · 10+ Years Experience

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STRATEGY #1

They Never Rely on One Audience

Big spenders always have 3+ audiences running simultaneously.

WHAT BIG ADVERTISERS DO:

- ✓ Run 3-5 audience segments simultaneously
- ✓ Test broad vs interest vs lookalike always
- ✓ Let data decide — not gut feeling
- ✓ Scale winners, kill losers weekly

WHAT MOST SOLOS DO:

- ✗ Run one audience until budget runs out
- ✗ Guess which audience 'feels right'
- ✗ Never test broad audiences (they're scared)
- ✗ Keep losing ads running hoping they improve

THE BREAKDOWN:

Big advertisers know that no single audience lasts forever. Meta's algorithm changes, audiences fatigue, and costs spike. The solution is simple: always have multiple audiences in testing. When one burns out, another is already warming up. They typically run one broad audience (no targeting), one interest-based, and one lookalike — all at once. This creates a constant pipeline of data. The winner gets scaled. The losers get paused. No emotion. Just numbers.

Create 3 ad sets immediately. Ad Set 1: Broad (no interests, just age/location/language). Ad Set 2: Your best interest stack. Ad Set 3: Lookalike of your best customers or leads. Same budget each. Run for 7 days. Scale the winner by 20% every 3 days.

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They Test Creatives Systematically

Winners aren't found by luck — they're found by volume and process.

WHAT BIG ADVERTISERS DO:

- ✓ Launch 5-10 new creatives every week
- ✓ Test one variable at a time (hook, CTA, format)
- ✓ Kill underperformers within 48-72 hours
- ✓ Document every winner and why it worked

WHAT MOST SOLOS DO:

- ✗ Run the same creative for weeks hoping it works
- ✗ Change everything at once when it fails
- ✗ Never know why something worked or didn't
- ✗ Make decisions based on feel, not data

THE BREAKDOWN:

The biggest advertisers in the world treat creative like a factory. They have a process: generate hooks, test hooks, find the winner, build variations of the winner, test those, scale the best. They never fall in love with a creative. A video that worked last month gets retired this month. The goal is always finding the next winner before the current one dies. Most solo entrepreneurs do the opposite — they run one creative until it stops working, then panic and change everything at once, losing all data in the process.

STEAL THIS:

Every week, launch 3 new hook variations of your best performing ad. Change **ONLY** the first 3 seconds. Keep everything else identical. After 72 hours, kill anything with a CTR below 1%. The surviving hook gets a full creative built around it the following week.

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STRATEGY #3

They Track Every Conversion Correctly

If your data is broken, every decision you make is wrong.

WHAT BIG ADVERTISERS DO:

- ✓ Server-side tracking + Meta Pixel combined
- ✓ UTM parameters on every single link
- ✓ Weekly data audits to catch drift early
- ✓ Attribution windows set intentionally

WHAT MOST SOLOS DO:

- ✗ Rely on Meta Pixel alone (misses 30-40% of conversions)
- ✗ Trust the numbers Meta shows you without verifying
- ✗ Never audit tracking — assume it works
- ✗ Don't know what attribution window they're on

THE BREAKDOWN:

Here's the brutal truth: if you're only using the Meta Pixel, you're missing between 30-40% of your actual conversions. iOS privacy changes, ad blockers, and cross-device journeys all create gaps that the pixel can't fill. Big advertisers combine server-side tracking (Conversions API) with the pixel to close these gaps. They also verify their data weekly — comparing Meta-reported conversions against actual CRM or Shopify data. When there's a discrepancy of more than 10%, they investigate immediately. Most solo entrepreneurs never do this audit and make scaling decisions based on completely wrong data.

This week: go to your Meta Events Manager and check your Event Match Quality score. If it's below 6/10, your tracking is broken and you're optimising against bad data. Fix this before spending another euro on ads. Set up Conversions API alongside your pixel — most platforms (Shopify, WordPress) have native integrations that take 20 minutes.

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They Have a Full Retargeting Stack

The money is in the follow-up. Always.

WHAT BIG ADVERTISERS DO:

- ✓ Retarget video viewers (25%, 50%, 75%, 95%)
- ✓ Separate campaigns for each funnel stage
- ✓ Dynamic ads for product viewers / cart abandoners
- ✓ Email + ads working together (not separately)

WHAT MOST SOLOS DO:

- ✗ Run one retargeting audience for everyone
- ✗ Show the same ad to cold and warm audiences
- ✗ No distinction between interest vs intent signals
- ✗ Email and ads run independently with no sync

THE BREAKDOWN:

Big advertisers think in layers. Layer 1: Cold audience sees a brand/awareness ad. Layer 2: People who watched 50%+ of the video see a testimonial or social proof ad. Layer 3: People who clicked but didn't convert see a direct offer. Layer 4: People who started checkout see an urgency ad. Each layer has different messaging, different creatives, and often different offers. This is how they get 4-6x ROAS when solo advertisers get 1.5-2x on the same budget. The message matches where the person is in the journey — not just who they are.

STEAL THIS:

Build these 3 retargeting audiences immediately: (1) Watched 50%+ of your video ad. (2) Clicked your ad but didn't complete the form/purchase. (3) Visited your landing page in the last 30 days. Each gets a different ad. Audience 1 gets social proof. Audience 2 gets an objection-handling ad. Audience 3 gets urgency + a direct offer.

They Sell the Outcome, Not the Product

Nobody buys a drill. They buy the hole in the wall.

WHAT BIG ADVERTISERS DO:

- ✓ Lead with the result the customer wants
- ✓ Use specific numbers and timeframes
- ✓ Show the before/after transformation clearly
- ✓ Remove every objection before it's raised

WHAT MOST SOLOS DO:

- ✗ Lead with features and what the product includes
- ✗ Use vague language like 'grow your business'
- ✗ Describe what the product IS, not what it DOES
- ✗ Wait for the customer to raise objections — then lose

THE BREAKDOWN:

The best performing ads in any niche lead with a very specific transformation. Not 'improve your ROAS' but 'cut your cost per lead from EUR45 to EUR12 in 3 weeks without changing your budget.' Specificity creates credibility. Vagueness creates doubt. Big advertisers spend enormous time on the single sentence that opens their ad — because they know 80% of conversions are decided in the first 3 seconds. They also pre-handle objections inside the ad itself: 'No long-term contract. No agency fees. No fluff.' Every objection removed is a barrier to conversion eliminated.

Rewrite your current ad headline using this formula: [Specific Result] + [Timeframe] + [Without the thing they hate]. Example: 'Double your ad leads in 30 days — without increasing your budget or hiring an agency.' Now test it against your current headline. You will be surprised by the difference.

NOW YOU KNOW WHAT THEY DO.

The question is:

Who's going to help you implement it?

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Then go back to their accounts — alone.

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See you inside,

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